16.4 Respiratory Distress Syndrome

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Grunting, nasal flaring, chest recession • RR 70/min • SpO_2 85%	**ACTUAL** **Impaired gas exchange** related to surfactant deficiency as evidenced by grunting, retractions and hypoxemia.	SpO_2 within the target range for the baby's gestation.	• Give CPAP or oxygen as prescribed. • Assist with giving surfactant. • Follow SpO_2, RR and blood gases. • Handle the baby as little as possible.	SpO_2 on target: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Working hard to breathe • Grunting	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective breathing pattern** related to immature lungs as evidenced by tachypnea and retractions.	Within 24–48 hours, the baby is working less hard to breathe.	• Position the baby so the airway stays open. • Suction only when needed. • Group care together so the baby uses less oxygen.	Better: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Cannot feed by mouth • On IV fluids	**RISK** **Risk for unstable blood glucose level** as evidenced by risk factors: stress and inability to feed.	Blood glucose stays normal.	• Give IV dextrose as prescribed. • Check glucose as the protocol says. • Start enteral feeds when ordered.	Glucose normal: **goal met**.